

February

10



1942

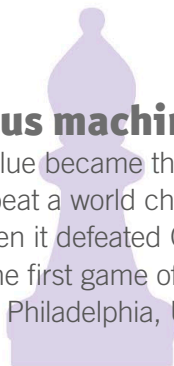
Going gold

The first gold record was given to US big band leader Glenn Miller for *Chattanooga Choo Choo*. Miller's record label presented him with a copy of the single sprayed in gold to celebrate 1.2 million sales. Today, gold records are awarded to singles that sell 500,000 copies in the USA or 400,000 copies in the UK.

1996

Man versus machine

IBM's Deep Blue became the first computer to beat a world chess champion when it defeated Garry Kasparov in the first game of a match held in Philadelphia, USA.



Also on this day

1763 The Treaty of Paris ended the Seven Years' War, the first truly global conflict, which had spread from Europe to the Americas.

1863 The patent for the first artificial leg was granted to US inventor Dubois D Parmelee.

2013 Pope Benedict XVI declared his intention to retire. He was the first pope to resign since Gregory XII in 1415.

Born this day

1835 Christian Andreas Victor Hensen, German zoologist. He discovered the important part played by minute aquatic organisms, which he called "plankton", in marine food chains.

1842 Agnes Mary Clerke, Irish astronomer. Her book *A Popular History of Astronomy During the Nineteenth Century* simplified the science of astronomy for Victorian readers.

1722

A pirate's end

Swashbuckling pirate Bartholomew "Black Bart" Roberts died in battle. During his life he had plundered about 400 ships in the Caribbean and off the coasts of the Americas and Africa. After the British Royal Navy shot him, his body was buried at sea and never found.

